



My Rock and My Fortress

MASADA COLLEGE

Early Learning Centre

Kindergarten to Year 12

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TO WHOM IT MAY CONCERN

NATHAN BELZYCKI has been a student at Masada College, St Ives, since 2014. He will complete his Higher School Certificate studies in 2019.

Nathan is a conscientious, hardworking student who has shown dedication and perseverance in all of his studies. He has shown special skills in Science, participating in the University of Newcastle Science and Engineering Challenge in 2017.

Not only does he have a positive attitude to learning, but he has played an active role in other aspects of College life. Nathan has represented the College in a number of sports, including soccer, futsal, rugby and athletics. His service to the school has been extensive and it is reflective of Nathan's enthusiastic attitude and willingness to participate. He received Full Colours for service to futsal and athletics, recognising his 5 year commitment to these sports. He was also the driving force behind the establishment of a year 12 Futsal team in 2019, a great achievement when most students are focused mainly on academic pursuits. He has coached junior soccer teams, played club soccer and gained refereeing qualifications, indicative of his commitment.

Nathan is young man of maturity and sensitivity. He is a courteous, responsible and resourceful person who sets a fine example to his peers. Nathan's social interactions reflect his positive, friendly demeanour and a fine sense of humour. I have no doubt that Nathan will succeed in all his future endeavours and have no hesitation in recommending him unreservedly to you.

Yours sincerely,

Lyn Rutherford

Year 12 Coordinator

LLB, BA, MA, Dip Ed (University of Sydney)

MASADA COLLEGE



Nathan Belzycki

The Masada Prize for Academic Achievement

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College Principal
Head of Senior School

26 September 2019
26 Elul 5779

Date

MASADA COLLEGE



Nathan Belzycki

The Peter Nixon Prize for Physics


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College Principal
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Date



Year 12, 2019

Semester Two Report

Nathan Belzycki

Year Patron Comment:

It is extremely pleasing to see that Nathan has applied himself to all subject areas this semester. He has shown that he is a capable student with the ability to achieve impressive results, resulting in him being awarded the Masada Prize for Academic Achievement. He has a flair for Mathematics and the Sciences and in particular, he is commended for gaining The Peter Nixon Prize for Physics. I have always valued Nathan's courtesy, reliability and openness. These are qualities that will hold him in great stead in his future.

Ms Lyn Rutherford



College Principal

Mr Martin Tait



Head of Senior School

Ms Megan Laing

Year 12 Higher School Certificate Course

Masada College reports on your child's progress with written reports twice a year and through interviews and meetings. You may contact the School to discuss this report and your child's progress with the Teacher, Head of Learning Area, Year Patron or Head of Learning and Teaching.

Key to Grades

A - Advanced Achievement: The student demonstrates extensive knowledge of content and understanding of course concepts, and applies highly developed skills and processes in a wide variety of contexts. In addition, the student demonstrates creative and critical thinking skills using perceptive analysis and evaluation. The student effectively communicates complex ideas and information.

B - High Achievement: The student demonstrates thorough knowledge of content and understanding of course concepts, and applies well-developed skills and processes in a variety of contexts. In addition, the student demonstrates creative and critical thinking skills using analysis and evaluation. The student clearly communicates complex ideas and information.

C - Satisfactory Achievement: The student demonstrates sound knowledge of content and understanding of course concepts, and applies skills and processes in a range of familiar contexts. In addition, the student demonstrates skills in selecting and integrating information and communicates relevant ideas in an appropriate manner.

D - Developing Achievement: The student demonstrates a basic knowledge of content and understanding of course concepts, and applies skills and processes in some familiar contexts. In addition, the student demonstrates skills in selecting and using information and communicates ideas in a descriptive manner.

E - Elementary Achievement: The student demonstrates an elementary knowledge of content and understanding of course concepts, and applies some skills and processes with guidance. In addition, the student demonstrates elementary skills in recounting information and communicating ideas.

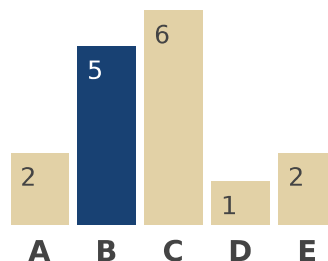
Assessment is based on formal assessment tasks. Grades are awarded for each listed course outcome and the course grade is a summary of student achievement in that course to date.

Chemistry

Course Description

In Semester 2, students analysed the structure of and predicted the reactions involving carbon compounds. They also described and evaluated chemical systems used to design and analyse chemical processes. Their practical skills were assessed and they completed a Trial Higher School Certificate Examination which tested their course knowledge and skills.

Grade: B



Total students in cohort: 16

Learning Dispositions	Always	Usually	Sometimes	Seldom
Uses learning time productively	☐	☐	☐	☐
Respects others in the classroom	☐	☐	☐	☐
Collaborates well with others	☐	☐	☐	☐
Completes tasks to the best of their ability	☐	☐	☐	☐
Is well organised	☐	☐	☐	☐
Learns well independently	☐	☐	☐	☐
Responds effectively to feedback	☐	☐	☐	☐

Comment

Nathan is a diligent student who exhibits a very focused and mature approach to learning. In the Trial Examination he showed an improvement in his overall knowledge, especially in the extended response questions. He can perform multistep calculations using stoichiometric equations with clear setting out. Nathan is also able to analyse and formulate appropriate responses to unfamiliar questions. He should continue to practise past papers in preparation for the Higher School Certificate.

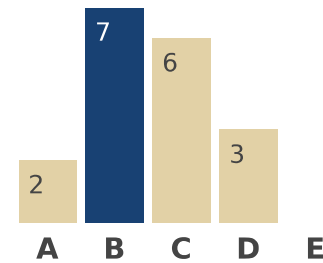
Ms Susan Virgona

Economics

Course Description

In Semester 2, students have been studying the key economic issues facing Australia, including economic growth, inflation and unemployment. Students have also examined the economic policies used by governments to address events in the Australian and global economies. The Term Two and Three assessment tasks focused on applying economic theory to contemporary events in the Australian economy, with a focus on how recent global developments, such as the trade war between the US and China which could affect consumers, firms and the government.

Grade: B



Total students in cohort: 18

Learning Dispositions	Always	Usually	Sometimes	Seldom
Uses learning time productively				
Respects others in the classroom				
Collaborates well with others				
Completes tasks to the best of their ability				
Is well organised				
Learns well independently				
Responds effectively to feedback				

Comment

Nathan has performed to a consistently high standard in the Economics course. In his Trial Examination, however, Nathan did not achieve to his usual standard. He did not provide sufficient detail or examples required in the short response section. In addition, Nathan wrote relatively superficial essays that did not demonstrate strong content knowledge or an in-depth understanding of current economic events. He should carefully review his Trial examination responses and identify areas where he could add additional information, statistics and quotes. Nathan should also be regularly completing past Higher School Certificate Examination papers and submit these to his teacher for feedback.

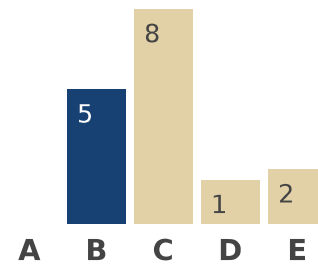
Mr Alexander Symonds

English Standard

Course Description

This semester Standard English students studied Module B: Close Study of Text The Curious Incident of the Dog in the Night-time and completed an extended response as an assessment task. Module C: Craft of Writing developed skills in the composition of discursive, imaginative, reflective, persuasive and informative tasks. Skills in analysis and reflection of writing were developed in the context of various short prescribed texts. Students were assessed through the composition of a narrative and reflection statement.

Grade: B



Total students in cohort: 16

Learning Dispositions	Always	Usually	Sometimes	Seldom
Uses learning time productively	☐	☐	☐	☐
Respects others in the classroom	☐	☐	☐	☐
Collaborates well with others	☐	☐	☐	☐
Completes tasks to the best of their ability	☐	☐	☐	☐
Is well organised	☐	☐	☐	☐
Learns well independently	☐	☐	☐	☐
Responds effectively to feedback	☐	☐	☐	☐

Comment

Nathan has continued to apply himself in the Standard English course. He is focused in class and is trying to meet the demands of the set work. There has been a gradual improvement with Nathan's written responses this year, due to him wanting to enhance his writing as well as completing practice essays. Nathan still needs to work on his engagement with the question in a more sophisticated manner as well as the inclusion of the most appropriate examples to support his response. Nathan's result from the Trial Examination conveyed his short answers in Paper One were lacking engagement with the question as well as the inclusion of the necessary techniques. Nathan should work on refining his skills for short answers through completing regular practice questions as well as submitting work for feedback.

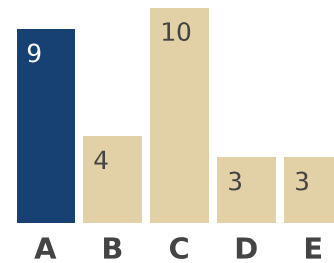
Mrs Megan Das

Mathematics

Course Description

In Semester 2, students have worked on exploring logarithmic, exponential and trigonometric functions using calculus, applications of calculus to the physical world and probability. Emphasis has been placed on developing a deep understanding of content and being able to apply learning and understanding to solve problems across several topics. This course has provided students an understanding of and competence in aspects of Mathematics applicable to the real world and supports concurrent studies such as Science and Commerce.

Grade: A



Total students in cohort: 29

Learning Dispositions	Always	Usually	Sometimes	Seldom
Uses learning time productively	☐	☐	☐	☐
Respects others in the classroom	☐	☐	☐	☐
Collaborates well with others	☐	☐	☐	☐
Completes tasks to the best of their ability	☐	☐	☐	☐
Is well organised	☐	☐	☐	☐
Learns well independently	☐	☐	☐	☐
Responds effectively to feedback	☐	☐	☐	☐

Comment

Nathan is a very bright student with an outstanding work ethic. All class and homework has been completed to a high standard. In class he is attentive and involved in class discussions, often providing a different way to solve a problem. He is an independent learner who can also successfully collaborate with others. His results in all assessment tasks have been of a high standard, in particular a near perfect mark in the Trial Examination. In preparation for the Higher School Certificate, Nathan should summarise each topic, ensuring that every piece of theory is covered and understood. This should be accompanied with a scaffold for solving each type of question. Once this is achieved, it is advisable for him to complete as many past papers as possible, under timed conditions, in order to further assess his understanding and improve his examination technique.

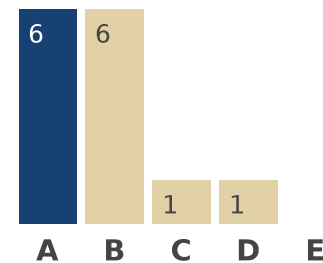
Mr David Steel

Mathematics Extension 1

Grade: A

Course Description

In Semester 2, students focussed on proof by induction, inverse functions, using calculus in rates, growth and decay, projectile and simple harmonic motion, counting with the binomial theorem and applications to permutations and combinations, and applications of series to financial problems. Emphasis has been placed on developing a deep understanding of content and being able to apply learning and understanding to solve complex problems across several topics. This course is designed for students with greater mastery of the 2 unit Mathematics course and provides a greater depth in several of the 2 unit topics and a higher competence in proof and physical applications of calculus including modelling patterns.



Total students in cohort: 14

Learning Dispositions	Always	Usually	Sometimes	Seldom
Uses learning time productively	☐	☐	☐	☐
Respects others in the classroom	☐	☐	☐	☐
Collaborates well with others	☐	☐	☐	☐
Completes tasks to the best of their ability	☐	☐	☐	☐
Is well organised	☐	☐	☐	☐
Learns well independently	☐	☐	☐	☐
Responds effectively to feedback	☐	☐	☐	☐

Comment

Nathan is a conscientious student who has continued to achieve impressive results this semester, ranking him as one of the top students in this course. In class, Nathan is focused and completes set work to a high standard. While Nathan's Trial Examination indicated that he has a sound understanding of the work covered, it also indicated that there are a number of areas that will require further attention. It is advisable for Nathan to correct any errors made and seek assistance if necessary. He should also continue to practise past Higher School Certificate papers under timed conditions to assess his understanding and refine his techniques and methodologies to solve these problems as efficiently as possible.

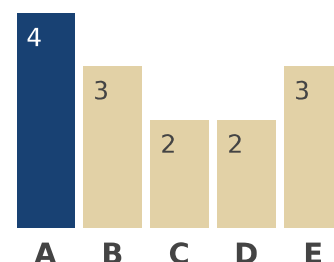
Mr David Steel

Physics

Course Description

In Semester 2, students have described and analysed evidence for the properties of light and evaluated the implications of this evidence for modern theories of physics. They have explained and analysed the evidence supporting the relationship between astronomical events and the formation of atoms and related these to the development of the current model of the atom. They have further developed their scientific, critical thinking and communication skills. They were assessed in a test based on their research on various aspects of the properties of light. The Trial Higher School Certificate Examination assessed their Physics knowledge and skills.

Grade: A



Total students in cohort: 14

Learning Dispositions	Always	Usually	Sometimes	Seldom
Uses learning time productively		☒		
Respects others in the classroom	☒			
Collaborates well with others	☒			
Completes tasks to the best of their ability	☒			
Is well organised	☒			
Learns well independently	☒			
Responds effectively to feedback		☒		

Comment

Nathan has an excellent understanding of concepts in Physics and the ability to interpret questions and write clear, concise answers. He achieved a mark of 81% in the Trial Examination. In the assessment task, based on research from Module 7, The Nature of Light, Nathan showed a thorough understanding of the topic and was able to clearly explain concepts, both theoretically and mathematically. Nathan has worked consistently and conscientiously over the past two years and this has enabled him to develop into a highly competent Physics student. He should continue to refine his examination technique and consolidate his knowledge by working on past papers and comparing his responses to marking criteria.

Ms Deborah Joffe